

Stretching for Seniors Over 60 - Printable Pack

From *Stretching for Seniors Over 60* by Margaret Hale (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need.

Appendix A - The 8-Week Tracker

A tick for the morning routine, a tick for the evening routine, and the letter of what else you did (A, B or C for the full routine; N, S, U, L, H, K, C, W for the problem routines: neck, shoulders, upper back, lower back, hips, knees, calves, wrists).

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Holds (seconds)	How it felt (1 to 5)
1									
2									
3									
4									
5									
6									
7									
8									

The month after (a tick a day)

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Notes
9								
10								
11								

12								
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The Test Sheet

Chair sit-and-reach: front edge of a chair against a wall; one leg straight, heel down, toes up; hands on top of each other; straight back; reach slowly toward the toes and hold two seconds; measure fingertips to toes (minus short, zero touching, plus past). Better leg, best of two.

Back scratch: one hand over the shoulder and down the back, the other up the back from below; measure the gap between the middle fingertips (minus apart, zero touching, plus overlapping). Better side, best of two.

	Week 1	Week 8	3 months later	6 months later	9 months later
Date					
Chair sit-and-reach (inches)					
Back scratch (inches)					
Neck turn: how far past the shoulder?					
Calf check: knee to the wall, heel down?					
Hip check: knee to chest, other leg still?					
My tightest area					

The normal ranges (the middle half of people of that age; inches)

Age	Sit-and-reach, men	Sit-and-reach, women	Back scratch, men	Back scratch, women
60 to 64	-2.5 to +4.0	-0.5 to +5.0	-6.5 to 0.0	-3.0 to +1.5
65 to 69	-3.0 to +3.0	-0.5 to +4.5	-7.5 to -1.0	-3.5 to +1.5
70 to 74	-3.5 to +2.5	-1.0 to +4.0	-8.0 to -1.0	-4.0 to +1.0
75 to 79	-4.0 to +2.0	-1.5 to +3.5	-9.0 to -2.0	-5.0 to +0.5
80 to 84	-5.5 to +1.5	-2.0 to +3.0	-9.5 to -2.0	-5.5 to 0.0

85 to 89	-5.5 to +0.5	-2.5 to +2.5	-10.0 to -3.0	-7.0 to -1.0
90 to 94	-6.5 to -0.5	-4.5 to +1.0	-10.5 to -4.0	-8.0 to -1.0

My Precautions

From the doctor, surgeon or physiotherapist. Keep this with the routine cards.

Condition	Stretches to leave out or change	Until	Who said so

The pain rules

Stop at once for: sharp pain; pain in a joint rather than a pull in a muscle; pins and needles; numbness; pain that travels down an arm or a leg; dizziness; a click that hurts. A pull that fades in seconds is right. An ache the next day means less range and a shorter hold. A hot, swollen joint is rested, not stretched.

The Routine Cards

The numbers are the stretches in Part 2 of the book. Comfortable pull, breathe, both sides, never bounce, slowly out.

Morning (5 minutes, in bed and on the edge of the bed)

Stretch	How long
36 Full-Body Morning Reach	5 reaches of 10 seconds
27 Pelvic Tilt	10 tilts of 5 seconds
25 Single Knee to Chest	20 seconds each leg
26 Knee Rolls	5 rolls each side
Sit up: 4 Shoulder Rolls and Blade Squeeze	5 rolls each way, 5 squeezes
3 Neck Turn, 2 Neck Side Tilt	15 seconds each way

Evening (5 minutes, on the bed)

Stretch	How long
28 Lying Hamstring Stretch with a Strap	30 seconds each leg
29 Lying Figure Four (or 30 Butterfly)	30 seconds each side (45 seconds)
25 Single Knee to Chest	20 seconds each leg
26 Knee Rolls	5 rolls each side
34 Lying Chest and Shoulder Opener	60 seconds
Ten slow breaths out. Cramps: 13 and 14 standing at the bed first	

Full body, Version A (seated, 15 minutes)

Stretch	How long
1 Chin Tuck	8 of 5 seconds
2 Neck Side Tilt	20 to 30 seconds each side
3 Neck Turn	15 to 20 seconds each side
4 Shoulder Rolls and Blade Squeeze	5 each way; 5 squeezes
5 Seated Chest Opener	20 to 30 seconds
6 Upper-Back Hug	20 to 30 seconds
7 Seated Side Bend	20 to 30 seconds each side
8 Seated Spinal Turn	15 to 20 seconds each side
9 Seated Hamstring Stretch	20 to 30 seconds each leg
10 Seated Figure Four	20 to 30 seconds each side
11 Seated Calf and Ankle Stretch with a Strap	20 to 30 seconds each leg
12 Wrist, Finger and Forearm Stretch	15 to 20 seconds each position

Full body, Version B (standing and seated, 15 minutes)

Stretch	How long
13 Standing Calf Stretch at the Wall	30 seconds each leg
14 Bent-Knee Calf Stretch	30 seconds each leg
15 Standing Thigh Stretch	30 seconds each leg
16 Standing Hip Flexor Stretch	30 seconds each leg
17 Standing Hamstring Stretch	30 seconds each leg
21 Inner Thigh Stretch	30 seconds each side
22 Standing Back Ease	8 leans
18 Standing Side Bend	20 seconds each side
19 Doorway Chest Stretch	30 seconds, twice
24 Upper Arm and Back Reach	20 seconds each arm
20 Overhead Reach and Lengthen	3 reaches
Sit: 1 Chin Tuck, 2 Neck Side Tilt, 3 Neck Turn	5 tucks; 20 seconds each side

Full body, Version C (lying and standing, 15 minutes)

Stretch	How long
13 Standing Calf Stretch, 14 Bent-Knee Calf Stretch	30 seconds each leg, each
16 Standing Hip Flexor Stretch	30 seconds each leg
Lie down: 28 Lying Hamstring Stretch with a Strap	30 seconds each leg
29 Lying Figure Four (or 30 Butterfly)	30 seconds each side
31 Bed-Edge Thigh and Hip Stretch, or 35 Side-Lying Thigh and Hip Stretch	30 seconds each leg
25 Single Knee to Chest, 26 Knee Rolls	20 seconds each leg; 5 rolls each side
32 Cat and Cow	8 slow repetitions
33 Resting Back Stretch (or its seated version)	45 seconds
34 Lying Chest and Shoulder Opener	60 seconds
Sit up: 24 Upper Arm and Back Reach, 1 Chin Tuck, 3 Neck Turn	20 seconds each arm; 5 tucks; 15 seconds each way

The problem routines (5 to 8 minutes, once or twice a day)

Problem	Stretches, in order
Neck	1 (8) - 2 - 3 - 4 - 5 - 23 (8)
Shoulders	4 - 19 (twice) - 24 - 23 (8) - 34 - back scratch with the strap (20 seconds each side)
Upper back and posture	5 - 6 - 20 - 23 - 32 (cow) - 34 with the towel roll - 1
Lower back	27 - 25 - 26 - 28 - 32 - 33 - 16 - 22 (not with stenosis or leg pain)
Hips	16 - 31 or 35 - 29 or 10 - 30 - 21 - 26 (hip precautions: skip 29, 10, 30)
Knees and thighs	15 or 31 - 17 or 9 - 13 - 11 - seated knee straighten (10 each leg)
Calves and feet	13 - 14 - 11 with ankle circles - toe pull for the arch (30 seconds, 3 times) - roll the sole
Hands and wrists	12 - finger spreads and fists (10) - thumb to fingertips (5 rounds) - palms together (20 seconds)

Around the day

When	What
Before a walk	Moving warm-up only: march, ankle rocks, shoulder rolls, side steps (2 minutes)
After a walk	13 - 14 - 15 - 16 - 17 (30 seconds each leg)

At the desk, every hour	1 (5) - 4 - 7 - 8 - 12
At the television	9 - 10 - 11 - 5, one per break
In the car	Lights: 1, 4. Parked: 3, 2. Long drive: out every hour for 13 and 22
In the kitchen	13 and 14 at the sink; 19 in the doorway; 20 reaching for the shelf